CREATOR & VIDEO EDITOR MASTERCLASS

Reel Pipeline Studio

User Guide & Production Handbook

Key Features Covered in this Handbook:

- 3-Step Beat-Sync Reel Workflow with Content-Aware CLIP AI
- DaVinci Resolve-Style 1:1 Timeline with 60 FPS CTI Scrubbing
- Pro Lumetri/Resolve Color Grading, 3D LUTs & Dynamic 9:16 Reframe
- Multi-Layer Editing (T1 Text Track, A1 Audio Track & Quick Deletes)
- Zero-Loss DaVinci Resolve & Premiere Pro FCPXML / EDL Export

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Reel Pipeline -- Complete User Guide & Studio Manual

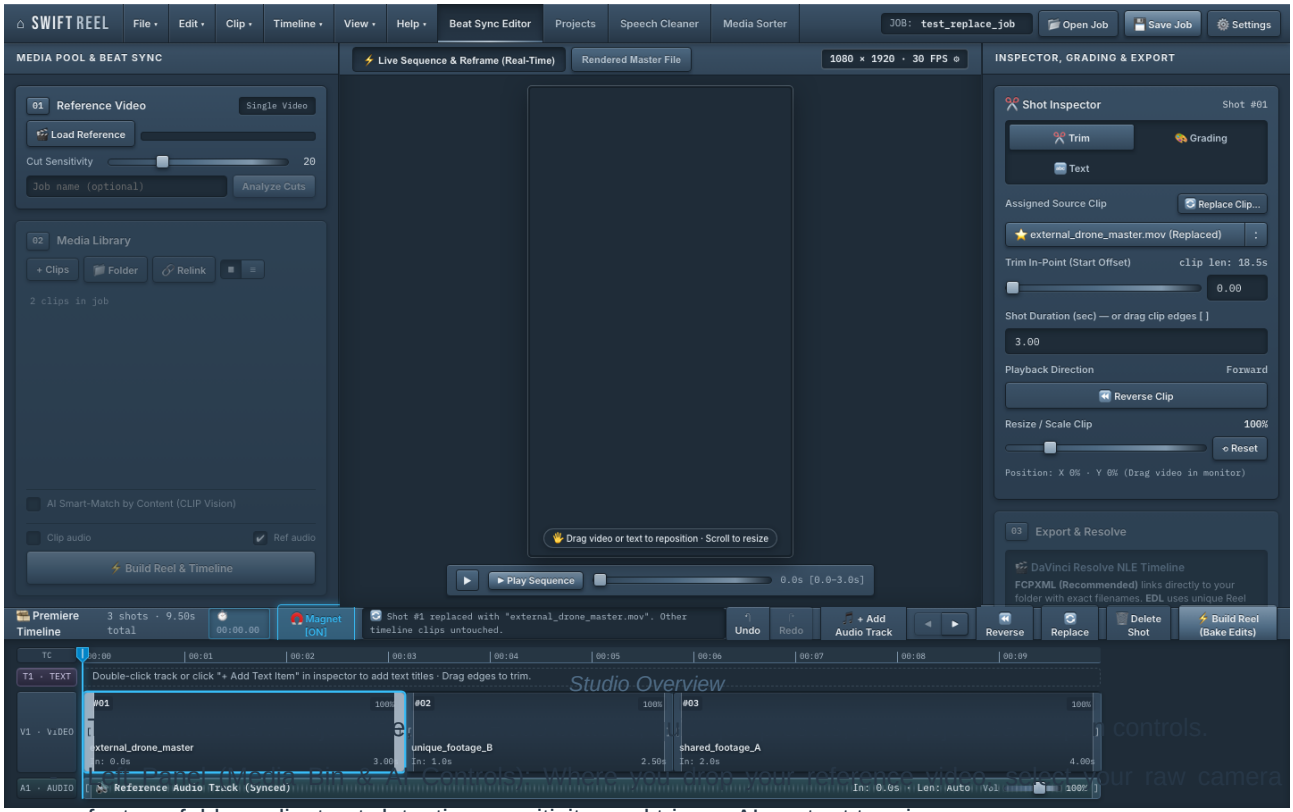
> *TIP: Welcome to Swift Reel Studio!*

> *TIP: Think of this guide as your personal masterclass. Whether you are an experienced video editor or creating your very first short-form video, this handbook walks you through every single tool, shortcut, and creative technique step-by-step.*

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1. The Studio Interface at a Glance

When you launch Reel Pipeline, you enter a dark-themed, DaVinci Resolve-inspired digital editing suite divided into four purpose-built zones:



footage folder, adjust cut-detection sensitivity, and trigger AI content tagging.

- Center Stage (Live Preview Monitor): Tri-deck 9:16 vertical playback monitor with clear visual differentiation:
- Reference Reel Tab (Amber): Displays your imported reference video with an amber glowing border and status pill (REFERENCE REEL · PACING & RHYTHM GUIDE). Clearly tagged as a read-only guide so you never mistake it for camera footage.
- [RUN] Live Sequence Tab (Cyan): Seamless zero-latency dual-deck playback showing your actual

working camera clips on the timeline (SHOT #01: clip.mp4), with live click-and-drag pan/zoom reframing and text overlays.

- Rendered Master Tab: Plays back the final high-bitrate baked video file after clicking Build Reel.
- Right Inspector Panel: Detailed per-clip controls for framing, pan & zoom, white balance, tonality curves, 3D LUTs, vignettes, fades, and text styling.
- Bottom Dock (Multi-Track Timeline): DaVinci Resolve-style continuous multi-track timeline featuring a Timecode Ruler (TC), Text Track (T1), Video Track (V1), Audio Track (A1), and interactive 60 FPS playhead (CTI).

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2. The 3-Step Beat-Sync Reel Workflow

Creating a viral, fast-cut, rhythm-matched reel takes under 3 minutes:

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[Step 1: Ingest Reference] [Step 2: Smart-Match Content] [Step 3: Build & Refine]

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Step 1: Analyze Your Reference Video

- Find any high-performing Instagram Reel, TikTok, or YouTube Short whose pacing and rhythm you admire.
- In the 01 Reference Video section on the left, click Load Reference and select your single reference MP4 or MOV.
- Keep the Cut Sensitivity slider at the default 20 (or raise it if you want only hard cuts detected).
- Click Analyze Cuts.
- What happens: PySceneDetect scans the video frame-by-frame, finds every cut point, and builds an exact rhythm map showing the duration of every single beat.
- Detected Shot List: Expanding the shot list displays 10 shots at a time with sticky headers and precise in/out timecodes for rapid review.

Step 2: Ingest Footage & Smart-Match

- In 02 Media Library, click [DIR] Folder to pick a folder on your Mac SSD, or click + Clips to select specific video files.
- The Media Library expands to fill the entire sidebar height with high-density thumbnails. Toggle between Thumb and List views anytime.
- (Optional AI Power) Check AI Smart-Match by Content (CLIP Vision).
- Type category keywords that match your video (e.g. food, kitchen, cocktail, exterior, person).
- Click [AI] Tag Content with AI.
- What happens: OpenAI CLIP analyzes your footage and matches your shots to the rhythm map by visual subject matter rather than random alphabetical order!

Step 3: Build the Reel

- Click [RUN] Build Reel & Timeline.
- Within seconds, your reel is compiled, color-graded, reframed to 9:16 vertical, and loaded directly onto the interactive timeline for fine-tuning.

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3. Mastering the Multi-Track Timeline

The timeline is designed to feel just like DaVinci Resolve and Adobe Premiere Pro:



Multi-Track Timeline

Linear Timecode & Playhead (CTI)

- Every second on the timeline is mathematically locked 1:1 to the playback monitor (120 px/sec).
- Drag the cyan playhead ([TIME] CTI) or click anywhere on the TC Ruler to scrub through your edit in real time at butter-smooth 60 FPS.

Trimming Clip In-Points and Out-Points (`[ ]`)

- Hover your mouse over the left edge of any video card to reveal the [handle. Drag it left or right to change where the clip starts.
- Hover over the right edge to reveal the] handle. Drag it left or right to lengthen or shorten the clip.
- Auto-Scroll Runway: There is a generous 650px blank runway past the end of the timeline. If you drag the last clip toward the edge of your screen, the timeline automatically scrolls horizontally with you!

Magnetic Snapping Tool (``)

- Toggle Snapping: Click the Magnet [ON] button on the timeline toolbar, or tap the [N] key on your keyboard (the universal Premiere Pro / DaVinci Resolve snapping shortcut).
- Cyan Magnetic Guide Line: When dragging clip trim handles, sliding text titles, or scrubbing the CTI playhead near a cut or layer boundary, an illuminated vertical cyan guide line (#38BDF8) snaps across all

timeline tracks, locking your edit to the exact sub-frame.

- Magnetic Snap Targets:
- Video Cut Boundaries: Snap text titles and playhead directly to shot transitions.
- Playhead (CTI) Position: Park the playhead on an audio beat or spoken cue, then drag a clip's trim edge to snap right to the playhead!
- Text Track Boundaries: Snap adjacent titles together without awkward gaps or text overlaps.
- Custom Audio Start/End: Snap video cuts and text layers precisely to musical drops or track starts.
- Sequence Start (0.00s): Easily align initial layers to the very first frame.
- Freeform Mode: Tap [N] or click the magnet button to turn it into Magnet [OFF] whenever you want unrestricted, sub-pixel dragging without magnetic pull.

Reversing Clips (`[REV]`)

- Click any clip on the V1 track, then click [REV] Reverse on the toolbar (or press [R]).
- The clip will instantly show a [REV] REV badge and play backwards in full original 4K/1080p resolution in the monitor!
- Non-destructive: Your original camera file is never touched or overwritten.

Replacing Clips with External Media (``)

- Isolated Shot Replacement: You can swap any individual shot on the timeline with an external video file from anywhere on your Mac SSD, even if it is not inside your media library folder.
- How to Replace: Select the shot card on the timeline, then click Replace on the timeline toolbar (or click Replace Clip... in the Inspector, or press [Option+R]).
- Auto-Pool Replaced Toggle:
- When ON (Default): The replacement footage is automatically added into your Media Pool with an instant thumbnail, allowing you to easily reuse it on other shots or select it from the Assigned Clip dropdown.
- When OFF: The replacement clip remains strictly isolated to that single shot on the timeline, keeping your Media Pool clean and untouched.
- Multi-Use Footage Protection: If other shots in your timeline share the same original clip from your media library, replacing this shot will never alter those other shots. Only the active shot is swapped.
- Full Live Monitor & Bake Support: The live monitor immediately loads and previews the new clip, and clicking [RUN] Build Reel (Bake Edits) bakes the replacement footage into the final rendered reel.

Deleting Layers & Clips (`[DEL]`)

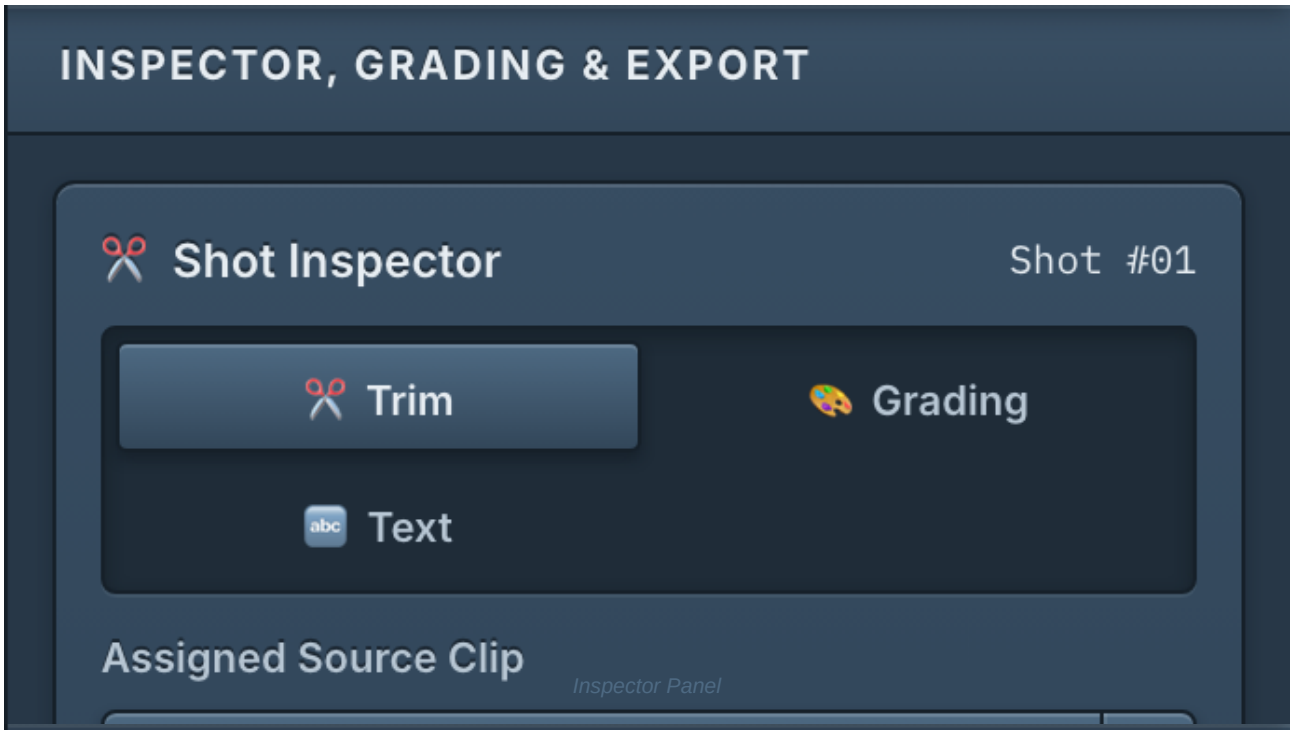
The timeline features a smart, context-aware delete tool:

- To delete a Text Layer: Click the text title on the T1 track, then click [DEL] Delete Text (or press [Delete] / [Backspace]).
- To delete a Video Shot: Click the video card on the V1 track, then click [DEL] Delete Shot (or press [Delete] / [Backspace]).
- To clear the Custom Audio Track: Click the A1 audio track, then click [DEL] Clear Audio (or press [Delete] / [Backspace]).

- Made a mistake? Press [Cmd+Z] anytime to undo up to 10 steps back!

4. Color Grading, 3D LUTs & Reframe

Click any clip on the timeline and explore the Inspector Panel on the right:



Inspector Panel



Color Grading Pane

Spatial Reframe (Pan & Zoom)

- Drag the Zoom slider to crop into the action (100% to 300%).

- In the live preview monitor, click and drag the video with your mouse to reposition the framing horizontally or vertically!
- Scroll your mouse wheel directly over the video to zoom in and out.
- Click [AUTO] Apply Reframe to All Shots if you want your framing style applied across the entire video.

DaVinci Resolve-Style White Balance

- Temperature Slider: Slide right for warm, rich golden amber tones; slide left for cool, cinematic blue tones.
- Tint Slider: Balance magenta and green tones with true photographic accuracy.
- Uses an exact mathematical RGB matrix that avoids the fake green/purple wash of generic web filters.

Curves, Tonality & 3D LUTs

- Tonality Curves: Choose between Standard Linear, Punchy S-Curve (Rich Contrast), Filmic Muted Roll-Off, or High-Key Clean Pop.
- Vignette: Add natural optical lens falloff to draw the viewer's eyes directly to the center of the dish or subject.
- Fades: Add smooth fade-from-black or fade-to-black transitions in tenths of a second.
- 3D LUT Support: Click Load .CUBE LUT to apply your favorite DaVinci Resolve or camera manufacturer color grading LUTs (.cube).
- 1:1 WYSIWYG Monitor-to-Bake Color Parity:
- What you see in the Live Sequence & Reframe monitor is rendered identically in your final master video file down to the exact highlight roll-off and RGB gain.
- Automatic iPhone HDR (HLG BT.2020) Tonemapping: When shooting on iPhone 12 through 16 Pro Max (Apple HLG / Dolby Vision Profile 8.4), Reel Pipeline automatically tone-maps the 1000-nit extended dynamic range to Rec.709 SDR using broadcast-standard Hable curve compression. Ice cubes, glassware, lime slices, and bright backlights maintain their rich texture without ever blowing out into harsh nuclear white.

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5. Text Titles & Typography (T1 Track)

Add stylish, modern captions and title cards that elevate your video:

- Add Text: Double-click any empty space on the purple T1 · TEXT track, or click + Add Text Item in the inspector.
- Position & Trim: Drag the text card along the timeline to choose when it appears. Drag its [and] handles to set how long it stays on screen.
- Interactive On-Screen Drag: In the live monitor, click and drag the text title directly to position it anywhere on screen!
- Custom Fonts: Click Upload Font (.ttf / .otf) to import your brand's official typography.
- Background Styles: Choose between clean transparent text, blurred frosted glass, semi-black badges, or glowing drop shadows.

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6. Audio Architecture: Reference Audio vs Clip Audio vs Custom Music

Reel Pipeline gives you studio-grade multi-track audio control designed specifically for short-form rhythm editing:

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AUDIO SOURCES COMPARED

[SOUND] REFERENCE AUDIO The soundtrack/music extracted directly from the reference video reel. Used as the master rhythmic pacing guide so every cut lands on the beat.

CLIP AUDIO The camera's original microphone audio (kitchen sizzles, dialogue, clinking glasses, ambient sound) embedded inside each raw video file.

[AUDIO] CUSTOM AUDIO (A1 Track) An external MP3/WAV/M4A song or voiceover loaded onto the timeline to replace the reference music.

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What does "Reference Audio" stand for?

When you load an inspiring Instagram Reel or TikTok reference video into the app, Reel Pipeline analyzes its visual cuts and extracts its audio track.

- Purpose: Acts as your reference soundtrack and tempo grid. When you build the reel, your raw camera clips are synchronized to the cuts and beats of this soundtrack.
- When to use it: When you want your finished reel to use the exact trending music or voice pacing of the reference video.

What does "Clip Audio" stand for?

Clip Audio is the natural sound recorded by your camera or smartphone microphone when shooting your footage.

- Purpose: Provides atmospheric richness -- such as sizzling steaks, pouring wine, crackling fire, footsteps, or natural room reverberation.
- How to toggle it: Check the "Keep Original Clip Audio" checkbox on the left panel (or in project settings).
- When to check it: When you want the viewer to hear delicious cooking sounds or live atmosphere subtly mixed underneath the background music.
- When to uncheck it: When your raw footage has distracting wind noise, camera operator chatter, or poor

quality camera audio, and you want a clean music-only master.

Adding Custom Music (A1 Track)

To replace the reference soundtrack with your own song or licensed track:

- Click [AUDIO] + Add Audio Track on the timeline toolbar and select any MP3, WAV, or M4A file.
- The A1 · AUDIO track lights up with a green waveform.
- Adjust Timing: Drag the left handle [to offset where the music starts. Drag the right handle] to trim its duration.
- Volume Control: Use the volume slider on the track header to mix background music between 0% and 150%.
- Layer with Clip Audio: If Keep Original Clip Audio is checked, Reel Pipeline automatically blends both tracks in stereo, giving you professional audio layering with zero clipping.

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7. Exporting for Social Media & DaVinci Resolve

When your edit is ready, click [EXPORT] Export Selected Formats on the left panel:

1. Direct Social Media Presets

- Instagram Reels & Stories: 1080×1920 @ 30 FPS, optimized for Instagram's compression engine.
- TikTok Master: 1080×1920 with high-bitrate audio and fast metadata start.
- YouTube Shorts (4K Master): 2160×3840 vertical 4K master file with pristine bitrate.

2. Industry Handoff (DaVinci Resolve & Premiere Pro)

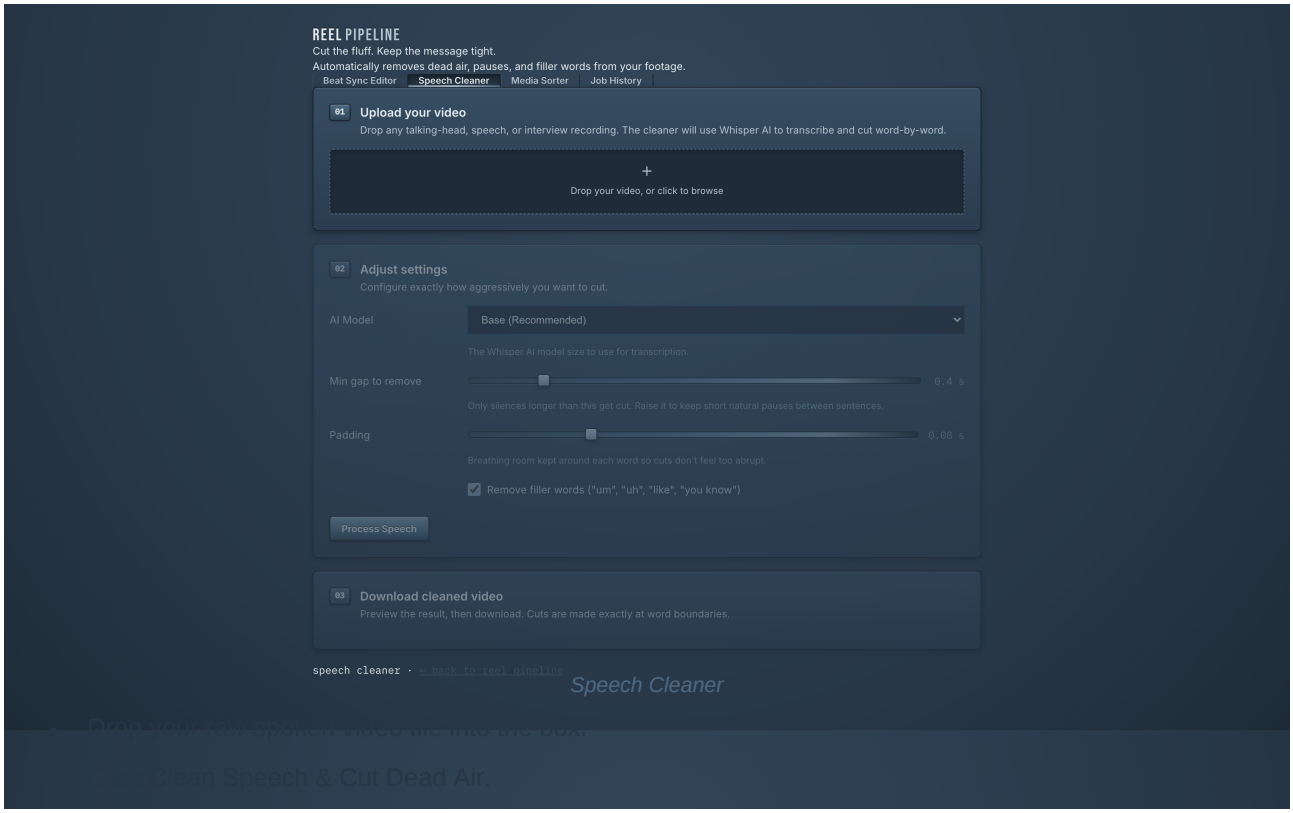
Never get trapped in an AI app! Reel Pipeline gives you full NLE project handoff:

- Download FCPXML (v1.9): In DaVinci Resolve, go to File Import Timeline and select the .fcpxml. Resolve instantly recreates your exact timeline, linking each cut directly to your original 4K/6K camera files on disk!
- Download EDL (CMX 3600): Industry-standard Edit Decision List with accurate SMPTE timecodes.

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8. AI Speech & Silence Cleaner

Need to turn a raw interview, talking-head video, or podcast into a punchy clip? Switch to the Speech Cleaner tab:

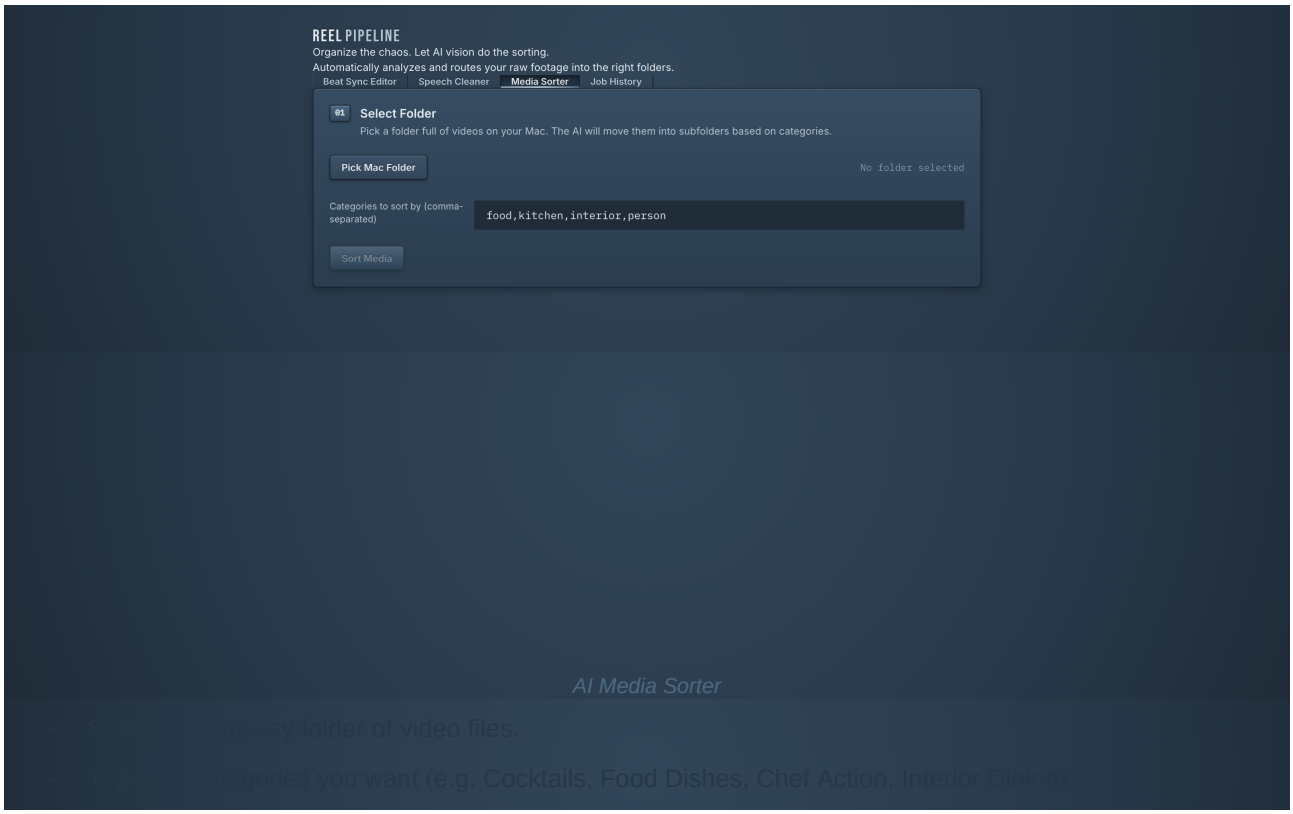


- What the AI does: OpenAI Whisper listens to the audio, transcribes every word with millisecond precision, and identifies all pauses longer than 0.45 seconds as well as filler words ("um", "uh", "er").
- It cleanly slices out the dead air and joins the speech segments together seamlessly without changing audio pitch.

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9. AI Media Sorter

Have a camera card with 50+ mixed clips? Switch to the Media Sorter tab:



AI Media Sorter

- Click [AI] Sort Media with AI.
- OpenAI CLIP inspects every video and automatically sorts them into organized subfolders on your Mac, ready for your next project.

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10. Keyboard Shortcuts Cheat Sheet

Shortcut	Action	Description
[Spacebar]	Play / Pause	Toggles sequence playback or active monitor preview
[N]	Magnet / Snapping	Toggles magnetic snapping on/off across all timeline tracks
[R]	Reverse Clip	Toggles reverse playback for the selected video shot
[Option+R]	Replace Clip	Replaces the selected shot with an external video file
[Delete] / [Backspace]	Delete Layer	Deletes the active text title, video shot, or audio track
[Cmd+Z]	Undo	Reverts the last action (up to 10 steps back)
[Shift+Cmd+Z] / [Option+Y]	Redo	Redoes the previously undone action
[Option+C]	Copy Color Grade	Copies the color grade of the selected clip
[Option+V]	Paste Color Grade	Pastes the color grade onto another selected clip
[Cmd+S]	Save Project	Saves the current edit as a .reelproj bundle
[Cmd+O]	Open Project	Opens an existing .reelproj bundle
[Cmd+B]	Build Reel	Bakes all edits and renders the timeline
[<] / [>]	Reorder Shots	Shifts the selected shot earlier or later in the edit
[Cmd+1]	Beat Sync Tab	Switches to the main Beat Sync Studio
[Cmd+2]	Cleaner Tab	Switches to the AI Speech Cleaner
[Cmd+3]	Sorter Tab	Switches to the AI Media Sorter

11. Pro Tips & Secret Shortcuts

- Copy & Paste Color Across Clips: Grade one shot perfectly, press [Option+C], click any other shot on the timeline, and press [Option+V] to copy the exact grade instantly.
- Smooth Reframe Scrolling: Place your cursor over the preview monitor and scroll up/down with your trackpad or mouse wheel to adjust zoom in real-time.
- Preserving 4K Camera Masters: Use the FCPXML export feature to take the AI's edit straight into DaVinci Resolve for final Dolby Vision or HDR grading.
- Zero-Lag Scrubbing: Click and drag directly on the Timecode Ruler (TC) above the video track to scrub at 60 FPS through cuts like a professional editor.

Happy editing with Swift Reel Studio!